

# Choosing a laptop processor (CPU)

General guidance for shoppers in India. Not specific to any one product; always check the exact configuration and current price before buying.

## Why the CPU matters

The processor decides how fast a laptop feels when you multitask, compile code, edit video or run many browser tabs. For everyday office and study work, almost any recent mid-range chip is enough. The CPU matters more for coding, video editing and heavy multitasking, and it matters less than the graphics card for gaming.

## Reading Intel names

Intel Core i3, i5, i7 and i9 are tiers, with higher numbers generally faster. The letter after the number tells you the power class. U-series chips are low power (roughly 15 watts) and suit thin, light, long-battery laptops. P-series chips sit in the middle. H-series chips (roughly 45 watts) are faster but run hotter and drain the battery faster. HX chips are the highest-performance mobile chips, found in large gaming and workstation laptops. Intel Core Ultra is a newer line that emphasises efficiency and includes an AI engine; Ultra 5, 7 and 9 follow the same low-to-high idea. Always check the generation: a newer i5 can beat an older i7.

## Reading AMD names

AMD Ryzen 3, 5, 7 and 9 are tiers in the same way. Chips ending in U are low power for thin laptops. HS chips are performance chips tuned for efficiency, and HX chips are the top-power gaming and workstation chips. AMD chips often give good performance per rupee and decent battery life, and their built-in graphics are usually stronger than Intel's older integrated graphics.

## Apple silicon

MacBooks use Apple's own M-series chips (M2, M3 and so on, with Pro and Max versions for more cores). They are known for strong performance with low heat and very good battery life, and the fans stay quiet in light use. The RAM is built into the chip package and cannot be upgraded later, so choose enough memory when you buy.

## Quick rules of thumb

For office, college and web browsing, a recent Core i3 or Ryzen 3 is enough and an i5 or Ryzen 5 gives comfortable headroom. For programming and multitasking, choose an i5 or Ryzen 5 and above, ideally an H-class or equivalent if you compile large projects. For video editing and 3D work, choose H-class, HX or Pro/Max-class chips and pair them with plenty of RAM. If battery life and weight are priorities, prefer U-class or Apple M-series chips over H and HX.